Nexora Technologies

Employee Handbook 2026

Version 3.2 • Effective 1 January 2026 • Owned by the People & Culture Department

This is a fictional document created for learning purposes.

1. About Nexora Technologies

Nexora Technologies is a software company founded in 2015 by Sara Malik and Daniel Okafor. The company builds cloud-based logistics software for shipping and warehouse companies. Its flagship product, RouteWise, helps businesses plan delivery routes and track shipments in real time.

Nexora's headquarters is located in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, with regional offices in Lahore (Pakistan), Riyadh (Saudi Arabia), and Nairobi (Kenya). As of January 2026, the company employs 640 people across all four offices.

1.1 Mission and Values

Nexora's mission is to make global supply chains simpler, faster, and more transparent. The company has four core values, known internally as the CORE values: Customer first, Ownership, Respect, and Excellence. Every employee is evaluated against these four values during the annual performance review.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard working week at Nexora is 40 hours, from Monday to Friday. Core hours, during which all employees must be available, are from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM local time. Outside core hours, employees may choose their own start and finish times, as long as they complete 8 hours per day.

During the holy month of Ramadan, working hours in the Dubai, Riyadh, and Lahore offices are reduced to 6 hours per day for all employees, regardless of whether they are fasting.

2.1 Hybrid Work Policy

Nexora follows a hybrid work model. Employees are required to work from the office at least 3 days per week. Tuesday and Wednesday are mandatory office days for all teams. The remaining office day can be chosen by each team. Employees who have completed their probation period may request to work fully remotely for up to 4 weeks per year, subject to manager approval.

New employees must work from the office 5 days per week during their first month to support onboarding.

2.2 Late Arrival

If an employee is unable to join during core hours, they must inform their manager before 10:00 AM through the team chat channel. Three unexplained late arrivals within one calendar month will result in a written warning from the People & Culture Department.

3. Leave Policy

All full-time employees are entitled to the following types of paid leave. Leave balances reset on 1 January each year.

Leave Type	Days per Year	Key Rule
Annual Leave	24 working days	Up to 5 unused days can be carried over to the next year
Sick Leave	12 working days	Medical certificate required for more than 2 consecutive days

Maternity Leave	90 calendar days	Fully paid; can start up to 30 days before due date
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Must be taken within 3 months of the child's birth
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	For immediate family members
Marriage Leave	5 working days	One-time benefit during employment
Study Leave	3 working days	Per exam, for approved courses only

3.1 How to Apply for Leave

Leave requests must be submitted through the PeopleHub portal. Annual leave must be requested at least 14 days in advance for periods longer than 3 days, and at least 2 days in advance for shorter periods. Sick leave should be reported to the manager on the same day, before 10:00 AM, and logged in PeopleHub within 2 days of returning to work.

3.2 Unpaid Leave

Employees who have used all their annual leave may request up to 30 days of unpaid leave per year. Unpaid leave requires approval from both the direct manager and the Head of People & Culture.

3.3 Public Holidays

Public holidays follow the official calendar of the country where the employee's office is located. Employees who are required to work on a public holiday receive a replacement day off, which must be used within 60 days.

4. Probation and Onboarding

All new employees serve a probation period of 3 months. For senior roles (Manager level and above), the probation period is 6 months. During probation, either party may end the employment with 7 days' notice. After probation, the notice period increases to 30 days for regular staff and 60 days for Manager level and above.

Every new employee is assigned an onboarding buddy from their team for the first 90 days. The buddy helps the new employee understand tools, processes, and team culture. Buddies receive a recognition voucher of 200 USD after completing a full onboarding cycle.

New employees receive their laptop and system access on their first day. Mandatory trainings on Information Security and the Code of Conduct must be completed within the first 14 days.

5. Compensation and Benefits

5.1 Salary Payment

Salaries are paid monthly, on the 25th of each month. If the 25th falls on a weekend or public holiday, salaries are paid on the last working day before it. Salary reviews take place once a year in April, based on the annual performance review results.

5.2 Health Insurance

All employees and their immediate family members (spouse and up to 3 children) are covered by the company's health insurance plan from their first day of employment. The plan covers outpatient care, hospitalization, dental check-ups once per year, and eye tests once per year.

5.3 Learning and Development Budget

Each employee receives an annual learning budget of 1,000 USD, which can be used for online courses, certifications, books, and conference tickets. Unused learning budget does not carry over to the next year. Requests above 500 USD for a single item require manager approval. Employees who leave the company within 12 months of a certification paid for by Nexora must repay 50% of the cost.

5.4 Other Benefits

Additional benefits include a monthly internet allowance of 40 USD for hybrid workers, free lunch on mandatory office days (Tuesday and Wednesday), a gym membership discount of 30% at partner gyms, and an annual wellness day off in addition to annual leave.

6. Performance Management

Nexora uses a performance cycle that runs from January to December. Each employee sets 3 to 5 goals with their manager by the end of January. A mid-year check-in takes place in July, and the final annual review is completed in December.

Performance is rated on a 5-point scale:

Rating	Label	Meaning
5	Outstanding	Consistently exceeds all goals and is a role model for CORE values
4	Exceeds Expectations	Exceeds most goals
3	Meets Expectations	Achieves all goals as agreed
2	Needs Improvement	Misses some goals; development plan required
1	Unsatisfactory	Misses most goals; formal improvement plan required

Employees rated 4 or 5 are eligible for an annual bonus of up to 15% of their yearly base salary. Employees rated 2 are placed on an Individual Development Plan (IDP) for 3 months. Employees rated 1 are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) for 60 days.

6.1 Employee Recognition

The Nexora Stars program recognizes employees who demonstrate the CORE values. Any employee can nominate a colleague through PeopleHub. Each quarter, one winner per office is selected and receives a certificate and a reward of 300 USD. The annual Star of the Year receives a reward of 2,000 USD and an extra 3 days of annual leave.

7. Code of Conduct

Nexora is committed to a respectful, inclusive, and safe workplace. Discrimination or harassment of any kind based on gender, religion, nationality, age, or disability is strictly prohibited.

7.1 Gifts and Conflicts of Interest

Employees may not accept gifts from clients or suppliers worth more than 50 USD. Any gift above this value must be reported to the Compliance team within 5 working days. Employees must declare any outside business activity or second job to the People & Culture Department before starting it.

7.2 Information Security

Employees must never share passwords, API keys, or customer data through email, chat, or personal devices. Company laptops must be locked whenever left unattended. Any security incident, such as a lost laptop or a suspicious email, must be reported to the IT Security team within 1 hour at security@nexora.example.

7.3 Reporting Concerns

Employees can raise concerns confidentially through the SpeakUp hotline, available 24 hours a day in English, Arabic, and Urdu. Nexora has a strict no-retaliation policy for anyone who reports a concern in good faith.

8. Resignation and Exit

Employees who wish to resign must submit a written resignation through PeopleHub and serve the notice period described in Section 4. All company equipment, including laptops and access cards, must be returned on the last working day. Unused annual leave is paid out in the final salary, up to a maximum of 15 days.

Every departing employee is invited to an exit interview with the People & Culture Department. Feedback from exit interviews is reviewed every quarter to improve the employee experience.

9. Contacts

Topic	Contact
Leave and PeopleHub questions	hr@nexora.example
Payroll and salary	payroll@nexora.example
IT and security incidents	security@nexora.example
Learning budget	learning@nexora.example
Confidential concerns	SpeakUp hotline (24/7)